

Research Reference: FSSAI Eat Right Campus & ICMR-NIN

Sourcing notes for every nutrition/waste-guideline number used in the app and pitch.

How to use this document

This compiles publicly available guidance from secondary sources (news coverage, summary tables, and academic references to the primary reports) rather than the primary ICMR-NIN RDA-2020 report itself. Figures here are good enough to defend in a hackathon pitch and to drive the app's demo logic, but before using any number in a real deployment or a formal submission, cross-check it against the primary source: ICMR-NIN, "Nutrient Requirements for Indians — Recommended Dietary Allowances (RDA) and Estimated Average Requirements (EAR) 2020," available via nin.res.in.

1. FSSAI Eat Right Campus

The Eat Right Campus initiative, run by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) under the broader Eat Right India movement (started 2019), certifies institutions — schools, colleges, workplaces, hospitals, tea estates, and similar campuses — on safe, healthy, and sustainable food practices.

Audit parameters (five categories)

- Compliance to food safety and hygiene
- Healthy diets
- Food waste management
- Promotion of local and seasonal foods on campus
- Promotion and awareness of food safety and healthy diets in and around campus

Source: FSSAI Eat Right Campus programme documentation; IIT Gandhinagar press coverage (first Indian educational institute certified, 2019, five-star rating).

Where ThaliMetrics maps to these criteria

FSSAI Criterion	ThaliMetrics Feature
Food waste management	Mess Dashboard: per-dish waste %, daily/weekly/monthly breakdown
Promotion of local/seasonal foods	Swap suggestions using Vellore/Tamil Nadu-relevant produce
Healthy diets	Weekly nutrient digest against ICMR-NIN reference intakes
Awareness of food safety and healthy diets	Student-facing digest + swap suggestions surfaced in-app

Real-world framing: this project is designed to double as a working prototype toward VIT pursuing Eat Right Campus certification, not just a standalone hackathon demo.

Scale of the programme

By 2024, FSSAI had certified over 500 hospitals as Eat Right Campus, alongside earlier waves of educational institutes and tea estates — indicating this is an active, growing national programme, not a defunct or symbolic one.

Source: FSSAI press release, Feb 2024 ("Hospitals go healthy!"); FSSAI Eastern/Southern Region Eat Right Campus pages.

2. ICMR-NIN 2020 Reference Dietary Allowances

The Indian Council of Medical Research – National Institute of Nutrition (ICMR-NIN) publishes India's official Recommended Dietary Allowances (RDA) and Estimated Average Requirements (EAR). The 2020 revision updated the 2010 figures upward for most vitamins and minerals, and FSSAI formally adopted RDA-2020 for food labelling compliance from July 2023.

Reference body weights (used as the basis for the RDA tables)

ICMR-NIN defines a reference Indian adult man as 20–39 years old, 65 kg; a reference adult woman as 20–39 years old, 55 kg. College students (18–22y) fall at the edge of this bracket — ThaliMetrics uses the adult table as the closest available official reference, flagged as a simplification throughout the app and docs.

Reference intakes used in the app (adult, moderate activity)

Nutrient	Men	Women	Note
Protein	0.83 g/kg body weight/day	0.83 g/kg body weight/day	Same coefficient both sexes; scales with the student's own weight
Iron	19 mg/day	29 mg/day	Higher for women — accounts for menstrual iron loss
Calcium	1000 mg/day	1000 mg/day	
Vitamin A	1000 mcg/day	840 mcg/day	Retinol equivalents
Vitamin C	80 mg/day	65 mg/day	
Folate	300 mcg/day	220 mcg/day	Figures vary somewhat across secondary sources — verify against primary report
Vitamin B12	2.2 mcg/day	2.2 mcg/day	
Zinc	17 mg/day	13.2 mg/day	
Fiber	30 g/day	25 g/day	

Sources cross-checked: ICMR-NIN "Brief Note on Nutrient Requirements for Indians" ([nin.res.in](#)); IGNOU Unit-2 course material on RDA for Indians (confirms iron 19–29 mg/day range and ~1000 mg/day calcium); Metabolic Health Digest summary of ICMR-NIN 2020; FSSAI RDA-2020 notification coverage ([foodsafetyworks.com](#), [nutraingredients-asia.com](#)).

Known gap in this research pass

The protein figure (0.83 g/kg/day) and the iron range (19–29 mg/day) are corroborated by multiple independent sources and are safe to quote confidently. Calcium (1000 mg/day) is similarly well corroborated. Vitamin A, C, folate, B12, zinc, and fiber figures above come from a single secondary compilation table and could not be independently cross-checked against a second source in this research pass — treat these as reasonable placeholders for the demo, and verify against the primary ICMR-NIN RDA-2020 report before quoting them as authoritative in front of judges who might push back on exact numbers.

Why this matters for the pitch

Judges may ask "where do your nutrient targets come from?" The honest answer: ICMR-NIN 2020, India's official reference standard, adopted by FSSAI itself for food labelling — a credible, non-arbitrary source, even though a few individual micronutrient figures in the current build should be treated as demo-accurate rather than lab-verified.